

A Your mailbox file seems to have been corrupted, but the file that you checked does not seem to be the right one. Microsoft gave up the MBX file format after Outlook Express 4. However, if this is really the file, you are in luck—you can retrieve at least the text part of all your e-mail by opening the file in a text editor. Notepad will not open such a large file, so use a better software such as NoteTab Light (www.notetab.com) or EditPlus (www.editplus.com). Note that while opening such a large file, the system may seem to hang, but let it open the file nevertheless.

In Outlook Express, open **Tools > Options > Maintenance > Store Folder** to determine where the mailbox files are stored. Outlook Express 5 stores e-mail in the DBX format. If this is also such a large file, try importing it to another identity or in another program such as Outlook. However, since you have already opened and closed Outlook Express several times, it may be impossible to retrieve the data and the file size may be just wasted space, which will reduce when you compact the folder (**File > Folder > Compact**).

Landscape printing

Q I have a Pentium III with 256 MB RAM and a 40 GB hard drive with Windows 2000 Professional, Service Pack 2. I have an HP Deskjet 670C printer installed. While printing any document in landscape orientation and draft mode, the printer prints from the right edge of the paper, irrespective of the right margin set. However, this does not happen with portrait orientation, or with normal and best modes.

Koyande

Via e-mail

A This seems to be a problem with the printer's drivers. You can find the relevant drivers at http://welcome.hp.com/country/us/eng/software_drivers.html. If this does not solve the problem, download the drivers for a printer from the same family (e.g., 660C or 690C) and try those instead. Also, when printing in landscape orientation, try using the Landscape (Rotated) option.

Modem network

Q After reading your article on connecting two PCs using modems, I tried it out with my friend. Both of us have Motorola SM56 PCI Internal Modems. The PCs connect successfully, but we cannot see our

DOS printing

Q How can I print from DOS to a printer connected to the USB port? I can print to the parallel port using the command **copy <filename> lpt1 /b**. What is the command for the USB port?

Kishore

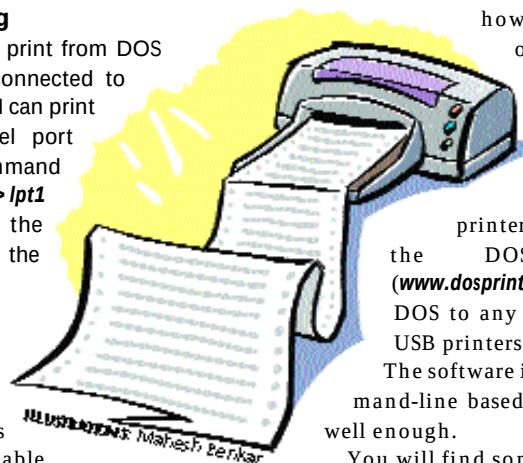
Jethanandani

Jaipur

A USB ports are not available from DOS and you cannot print directly to them. Microsoft claims that there is no solution for this,

however a few DOS operators have created DOS emulators that allow you to print to a parallel port or a USB port by emulating as a parallel printer port. You can use the DOSPrint utility (www.dosprint.com) to print from DOS to any output, including USB printers, fax-modems, etc. The software is completely command-line based, but does the job well enough.

You will find some similar tools to emulate the Epson Dot Matrix printer at www.filelibrary.com/Contents/DOS/15.html.

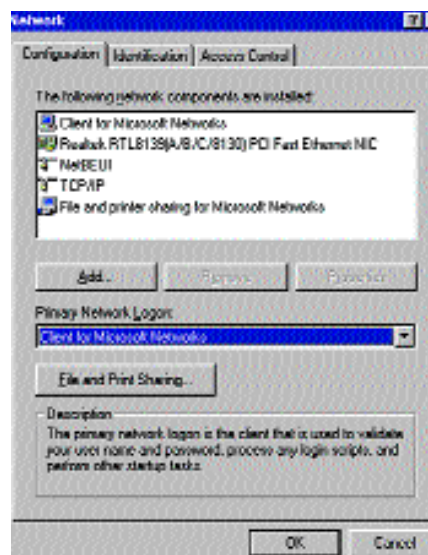


shared folders after typing **\\ipaddress\sharename**. When I open Network Neighbourhood and click Entire Network, it shows a message that says 'Unable to Browse Network'. Ping receives a successful reply.

Kuldip Modi

Via e-mail

A Both, you and your friend may need to be logged on to the network to be able to browse the shared resources. There are two ways to do this. Open **Control Panel > Network**. Set Client for Microsoft Networks as the 'Primary Network Logon'. The next time you start Windows, it will bring up a dialog box to log on to



You need to be logged on to browse shared resources

Windows. Enter a name and press [Enter]. Now, when you connect to the network, you should be able to browse each other's shared resources. The other way to achieve the same is by enabling the 'Log on to Network' option in the Dialing and Connection's properties, as described under 'I'm DUN for' (page 110).

Capturing movies

Q I have a Pentium 4 1.5 GHz machine with a 20 GB hard disk, 256 MB RAM, 32 MB video card, a TV tuner card and a 12x CD-Writer. I captured a movie using the TV tuner card and the size of the file was 30 MB for a 10-second clip! If I want to capture a two-hour movie, it will occupy around 20 GB of space. Without extra hardware, can I convert the raw file directly to an encoded format?

T. Gopal

Madurai

A Raw movie files are indeed very large, and unless you compress them while capturing, you can rarely hope to record more than a few minutes' worth of video. If the software bundled with your capture card does not allow you to compress the video, you can use other software such as VirtualDub (www.virtualdub.org) to do so. When capturing with VirtualDub, click **File > Open** to switch to capture mode. Click **Set capture file** to specify where the file should be saved. Click **Video > Format** to set the frame size and format. Open **Video > Compression** and select a codec for the captured video.